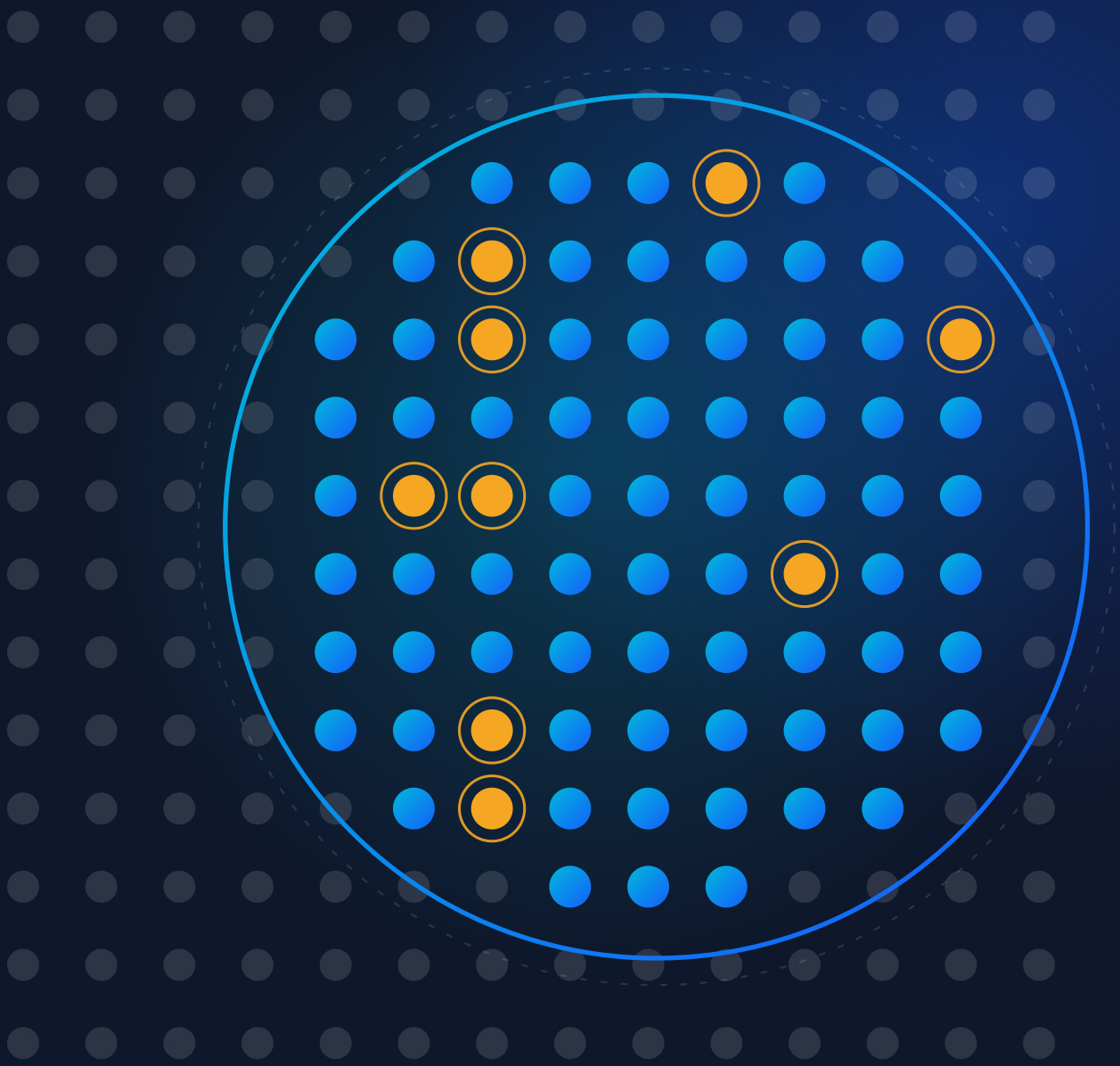
TRANSPUTEC

COPILOT READINESS · OCT 2026



WITHIN REACH NEVER MEANT TO BE

What Copilot can see.

Oversharing, the confidence gap, and the nine steps to take before you switch it on.

TRANSPUTEC RESEARCH

SAMPLE EDITION

ABOUT THIS REPORT

Mostly vendor surveys. We say so on every page.

There is no neutral census of Copilot readiness yet. The best available numbers come from companies that sell governance tools. We use them, label them, and keep them apart.

SOURCE 01

State of Microsoft 365 2026

ShareGate, 23 September 2026. Two surveys: 943 IT professionals and 851 IT leaders across nine countries including the UK. ShareGate sells governance tools.

SOURCE 02

AI governance survey

ShareGate, April 2026. 851 IT leaders in seven countries. Self-reported, run by the vendor.

SOURCE 03

Gartner Microsoft 365 and Copilot survey

186 organisations, March to May 2026, as reported by Opsin, a vendor. We have not read Gartner's own text.

SOURCE 04

Microsoft Learn guidance

Microsoft's Copilot oversharing blueprint and Restricted Content Discovery documentation, 2026.

SOURCE 05

CVE records

MITRE records for CVE-2025-32711 and CVE-2026-21520, with press reports for who found them.

READ WITH CARE

Percentages are self-reported and describe each survey's own respondents, not the market. Two different ShareGate figures are both 29%. They answer different questions, and we mark which is which.

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Copilot is not the risk. What it can reach is.

56%

of organisations now have Copilot fully deployed, up from 29% a year earlier[1]

77%

had at least one Microsoft 365 governance incident in the past year[1]

29%

of IT leaders say AI tools have surfaced sensitive data they should not have had[2]

1%

in 100 use a purpose-built governance tool; 57% rely on Microsoft's built-in ones[1]

What the surveys say

Adoption doubled in a year. Confidence did too: 93% of IT leaders say their Microsoft 365 governance is ready for AI. Yet nearly three in ten report AI surfacing data it should not have, and two in three learn about problems only after they happen.[1,2]

What it means

An assistant that answers from everything a person can open makes old permission mistakes visible at conversation speed: the broad sharing link, the former contractor, the folder nobody owns. The fix is mostly housekeeping. It is also tedious, which is why it gets skipped.

Our view: run the clean-up before the licences, not after the incident.

THREE PHASES

Remediate oversharing · Set up guardrails · Meet your regulations. Microsoft's own order, page 11.[4]

Sources: 1 ShareGate State of Microsoft 365 2026. 2 ShareGate AI governance survey, April 2026. 4 Microsoft Learn. All vendor-run surveys.

CHAPTER 01 · THE CONFIDENCE GAP

93%

of IT leaders say their Microsoft 365 governance is ready to support AI responsibly.[2]



29 IN 100 SAY AI SURFACED DATA IT SHOULD NOT HAVE

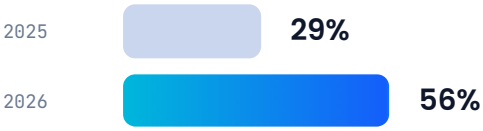
Confident. And one in three exposed.

01 · THE CONFIDENCE GAP

Adoption doubled. Governance did not.

Two ways of counting Copilot use, both rising. The definitions differ, so the two figures should not be added or compared with each other.

Full Copilot deployment



Copilot in production



HOW GOVERNANCE IS DONE

Built-in Microsoft tools	57%
Manual or internal policies	38%
No governance	4%
Purpose-built tool	1%

Share of organisations. ShareGate respondents.[1]

65%

learn about governance problems only after the fact. 35% monitor proactively.[1]

93%

have Copilot in production in the 2026 report, up from 82%. The April survey also finds 93% fully or partly deployed.[1,2]

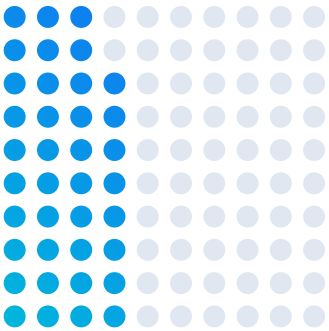
Source: 1 ShareGate, State of Microsoft 365 2026 (23 Sept 2026). 2 ShareGate, April 2026. Vendor-run, self-reported; no fielding dates published.

01

01 · THE CONFIDENCE GAP

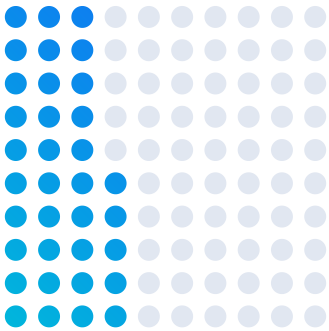
What goes wrong, and how often.

Across the past year, 77% of organisations had at least one Microsoft 365 governance incident. Three kinds account for most of what surveyed teams reported.



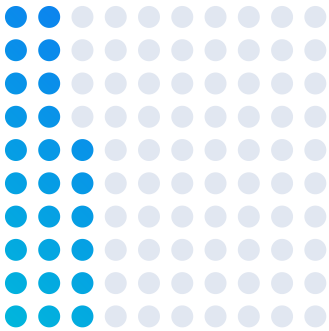
38%

left former employees or guests with access they should have lost[1]



35%

hit an audit or compliance gap[1]



26%

had sensitive content reach the wrong people[1]

Share of all organisations surveyed. Incidents counted include oversharing, stale access, audit gaps and shadow IT or AI. Self-reported.

OUR VIEW

None of these three is new. A leaver who keeps access, a link that was meant for one person, a library nobody reviews: IT teams have lived with them for years because they were hard to see and slow to exploit.

An assistant that searches across everything makes them fast to find. That is the real change Copilot brings.

Source: 1 ShareGate, State of Microsoft 365 2026. Vendor-run survey of 943 IT professionals and 851 IT leaders, nine countries.

02 · HOW COPILOT SEES YOUR DATA

It does not break the rules. It follows yours.

Copilot does not need a vulnerability to show someone the wrong file. It needs the wrong person to have access.

1

A person asks Copilot a question

It answers from content that person can already open.

2

It searches the places they can reach

Content across Microsoft 365 that their permissions allow them to open.

3

Whatever is overshared is now findable

A company-wide link, an old guest, a site with broken inheritance.

WHY A QUICK FIX IS NOT A FIX

Microsoft's Restricted Content Discovery hides chosen SharePoint sites from Copilot, but it is a temporary control. It does not change permissions: anyone with access can still open the content.[5]

WHAT IT COSTS

Microsoft cautions that overusing it reduces how complete Copilot's answers are. Changes to large sites can take over a week to apply.[5]

Source: 5 Microsoft Learn, Restricted Content Discovery. The three-step explanation is ours, consistent with ShareGate's finding that leaders expect Copilot's access to reflect appropriate permissions.

02

02 · HOW COPILOT SEES YOUR DATA

Two vulnerabilities, one lesson.

Both were fixed by Microsoft. Both are useful because they show where governance has to do the work that patching cannot.

ECHOLEAK · CVE-2025-32711

CVSS 9.3 CRITICAL

A zero-click flaw in Microsoft 365 Copilot that, according to its finders at Aim Security, allowed data to be pulled out of Copilot's context with no action from the user. Microsoft fixed it server-side in June 2025. No customer action was needed and there was no evidence of exploitation in the wild.[6]

COPILOT STUDIO FLAW · CVE-2026-21520

CVSS 7.5 HIGH

Researchers at Capsule Security showed that crafted text in a public SharePoint form could steer an agent into reading connected data and emailing it out. Data-loss rules did not fire because the email used a legitimate action. Microsoft patched it on 15 January 2026. Exploitation was shown only in testing.[6]

OUR VIEW

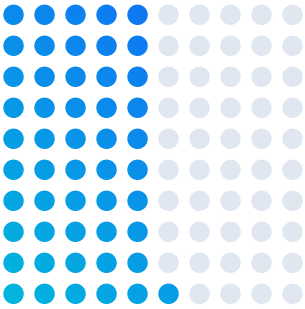
A patch removes a specific hole. It does not tell you what the assistant could reach, whether a form is public, or whether outbound email is monitored. Those questions belong to the organisation, not the vendor.

Sources: 6 MITRE CVE records for CVE-2025-32711 and CVE-2026-21520; The Hacker News (EchoLeak, finder per press); VentureBeat (Capsule Security, per press). We did not read the finders' own write-ups.

03 · WHAT IT LEADERS WORRY ABOUT

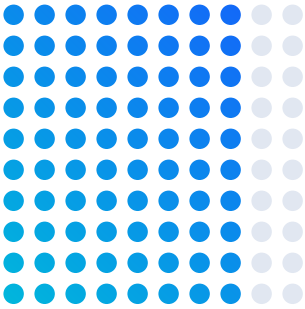
Oversharing first. Agents next.

A Gartner survey of IT leaders responsible for Microsoft 365 at 186 organisations, run March to May 2026, as reported by Opsin.



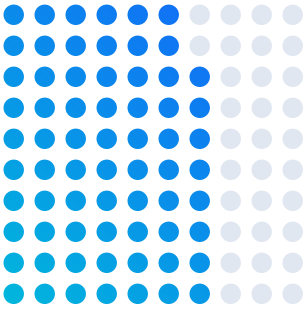
51%

name oversharing and data loss as the top barrier to deployment[3]



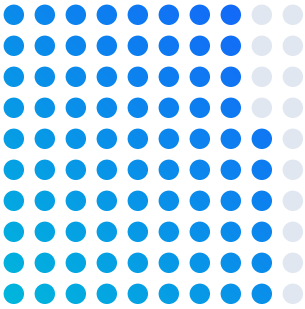
80%

want more governance controls before widely deploying agents[3]



68%

worry about Copilot agent sprawl[3]



86%

are limiting Copilot Studio deployments[3]

Gartner survey as reported by Opsin, a governance-tool vendor. We have not read Gartner's report.

UNRECONCILED

Another vendor blog quotes different figures from apparently the same research. Until the Gartner note itself is read, treat these four numbers as indicative, and look at direction rather than decimals.

OUR VIEW

The order of worries is the useful part. Oversharing is the problem in front of you today; agents multiply it tomorrow. Fix the foundation first, and agent rules become much easier to write.

Source: 3 Opsin, 18 June 2026, summarising Gartner's 'Microsoft 365 Copilot and Agents: Assessing Impact and Value in 2026'. The 86% is the share limiting Copilot Studio deployments.

04 · MICROSOFT'S NINE STEPS

The vendor's own order. Three phases, nine steps.

From Microsoft's Copilot oversharing blueprint. SharePoint Advanced Management is included with Copilot licences; Purview foundations come with Microsoft 365 E3, with extra features in E5.[4]

01 Remediate oversharing

- Find high-risk sites with Purview data risk assessments and SharePoint Advanced Management
- Apply interim protection: Restricted Content Discovery and DLP for Copilot
- Fix access: label sites, remove company-wide and anonymous links, review site access, assign owners

02 Set up guardrails

- Secure defaults: restricted access for critical sites, no Anyone links, labels at site creation
- Auto-labelling, default labels, DLP, insider-risk protection
- Keep watching: recurring risk assessments and alert reviews

03 Meet your regulations

- Assess against AI regulations in Compliance Manager
- Set audit-log retention and decide what happens to Copilot interactions
- Archive or retire inactive sites and apply retention policies

05 · A 90-DAY PLAN

Look, fix, hold.

Our reading of Microsoft's steps for a UK mid-market tenant. Illustrative: adapt it to your estate and licences.

DAYS 1-30
Look

- Run the site assessment. Rank sites by sensitivity and audience.
- List leavers, guests and ownerless sites with live access.
- Agree what Copilot may and may not draw on.

PLAY 01

DAYS 31-60
Fix

- Remove company-wide and anonymous links. Label the sensitive sites.
- Switch on interim protection for the highest-risk ones.
- Assign an owner to every site that keeps access.

PLAY 02

DAYS 61-90
Hold

- Set secure defaults for new sites and Teams.
- Start a monthly review of new exposure.
- Report three numbers to the board: exposed sites, stale access, time to fix.

PLAY 06

ASK YOUR IT PARTNER

"Which of our sites could Copilot answer from today that we would not want a new starter to read?"

Plays refer to The Resilience Playbook. This plan is illustrative and not Microsoft guidance.

SOURCES AND METHOD

Where this comes from.

1 ShareGate. **State of Microsoft 365 2026.** Press release, 23 September 2026; sharegate.com/guides/state-of-microsoft-365-report. Surveys of 943 IT professionals and 851 IT leaders, nine countries. Vendor-run; no fielding dates or research firm published.

2 ShareGate. **93% of IT leaders are confident in their AI governance but nearly 1 in 3 report data exposure incidents.** 20 April 2026; sharegate.com/blog/93-of-it-leaders-are-confident-in-their-ai-governance-but-nearly-1-in-3-report-data-exposure-incidents. 851 IT leaders, seven countries.

3 Opsin. **Opsin named in the Gartner Microsoft 365 Copilot and Agents research.** 18 June 2026; opsinsecurity.com/blog/opsin-named-2026-gartner-microsoft-copilot-agents-research. Gartner's own report was not read.

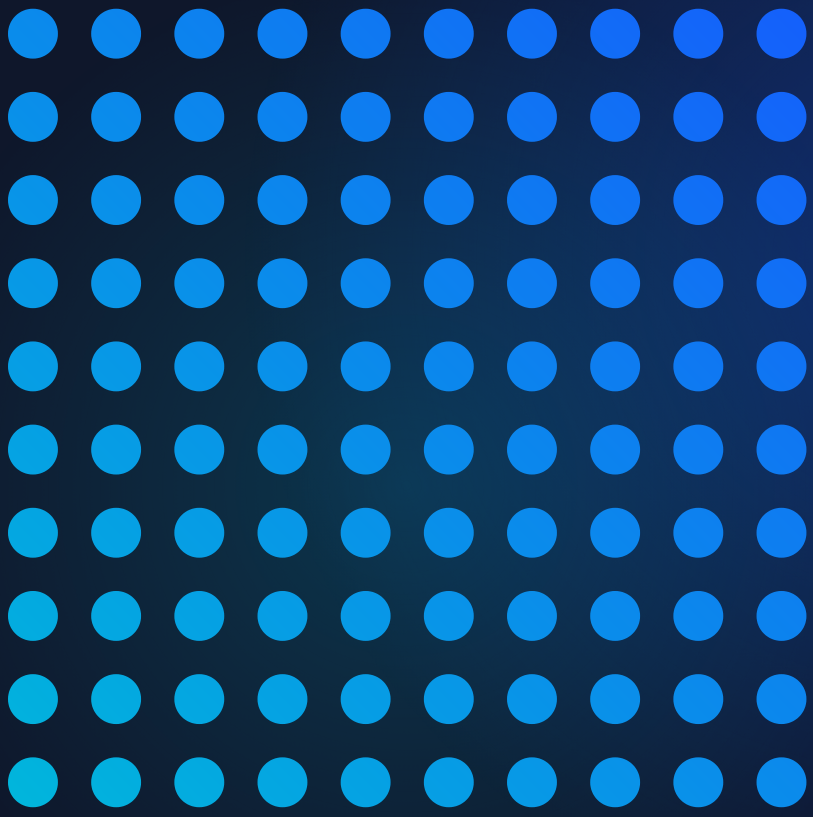
4 Microsoft Learn. **Secure and govern Copilot: foundational deployment guidance** and **Configure a secure, governed data foundation for Microsoft 365 Copilot.** learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-365/copilot/secure-govern-copilot-foundational-deployment-guidance

5 Microsoft Learn. **Restricted Content Discovery.** learn.microsoft.com/en-us/sharepoint/restricted-content-discovery

6 MITRE CVE records CVE-2025-32711 and CVE-2026-21520 (cveawg.mitre.org); The Hacker News, 12 June 2025; VentureBeat, 15 April 2026.

METHOD NOTES

Accurate as of 27 October 2026. Every survey here is run or relayed by a vendor of governance tools and is self-reported. We keep separate studies separate: ShareGate's two surveys have different samples and country lists, and two of its figures are both 29%. UK-only breakdowns are not available for most figures. The nine steps are Microsoft's; the explanations and the 90-day plan are ours.



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